

Henri Branken

Book Proposal Submission | 722 Kanji (JLPT N5, N4 & N3)

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Dear Tuttle Publishing

My work is a broad expansion on the existing "[Learning Japanese Kanji](#)" (hereafter called LJK) book in several ways:

- It includes all the kanji for JLPT levels N5, N4, and N3. In total, the book covers 722 kanji; this is 222 kanji more than LJK.
- For each kanji entry, the following is included:
 - The kanji glyph illustrated in 3 different fonts.
 - The stroke order of the kanji depicted in one picture.
 - A brief English explanation of the meaning of the kanji.
 - A breakdown of the kanji into smaller components and/or radicals.
 - A mnemonic linking the kanji meaning to the kanji components.
 - The (common onyomi and kunyomi) pronunciations of the kanji.
 - A mnemonic linking the kanji meaning to all pronunciations (the first 520 kanji).
 - A mnemonic linking the kanji meaning to the onyomi pronunciation(s) (the remaining 222 kanji).
 - Approximately 10 common words/compounds associated with each kanji.
 - A sample sentence for each kanji entry.
- Appendices:
 - Appendix A: The 214 Kanji determinatives.
 - Appendix B: The English meaning of the 47 prefectures of Japan, as well as the corresponding capital cities.
- Comprehensive Indices:
 - The main kanji index listing all 722 entries in alphabetical order.
 - A ロマジ (Romaji) Index.
 - Kanji Stroke-Count Index.

In light of all the specifications given above, it follows that the new book covers:

- Approximately 7,200 common words and compounds.
- Approximately 700 verbs.
- 722 sample sentences.
- Furthermore, a summary of all the kanji covered is provided at the end of each chapter.

Over and above the points already mentioned, the book has a professional layout thanks to beautiful LaTeX typesetting features.

What piqued my interest while doing online research for Japanese studies was the argument that one should preferably aim to directly attain JLPT N3 (i.e. skipping N5 and N4). This is because N3 has a lot more substance to it, and that it would equip one with more Japanese proficiency (in contrast to N5 or N4). In short, it is considered strategic in Japanese study circles to directly aim for JLPT N3.

As I initially worked through LJK, I grew frustrated for several reasons, which are listed as follows:

- The number of 'Common Words and Compounds' dramatically dropped with the chapter progression.
- No sample sentences were provided for the last 270 kanji entries.
- As a whole, the book did not cover all the kanji for JLPT N3. If we follow the common convention that N3 consists of ~620 kanji entries, it means that LJK has a deficit of ~100 kanji.
- Some kanji had convoluted mnemonics which made them strenuous to commit to memory.

In order to mitigate the above-mentioned hurdles, my own book sprang forth as a new project in order to cover all kanji up until JLPT N3. In a sense, I consider my work as an updated and expanded edition of LJK. As such, I regard my book as having potential. To have Tuttle edit the material and provide further guidance would polish this project to a gem of Japanese kanji resource material. In the end, though, I still find it important for a native Japanese person to proofread the material as well.

I finished my Master's Degree in Space Physics in the year of 2017. The degree involved a thesis, which may be found [here](#). As a result, I predominantly come from an academic background. Following my postgraduate studies, I worked as a Data Scientist (programmer) at Matogen Applied Insights for three and a half years. For a brief resumé, you are welcome to view my [LinkedIn](#) page.

The target readership of my book is mainly serious students of the Japanese language. This would typically entail students wanting to work through the JLPT levels.

A list of similar or competing books are as follows:

- [**Learning Japanese Kanji**](#)
- [**The Complete Guide to Japanese Kanji**](#)
- [**Essential Japanese Kanji**](#)

Lastly, the book consists of Chapters either containing 20, 25 or 30 Kanji entries. The approximate word count associated with each type of chapter is as follows:

- Chapter containing 20 Kanji entries: ~2800 words.
- Chapter containing 25 Kanji entries: ~3500 words.
- Chapter containing 30 Kanji entries: ~4200 words.

Please also consider the accompanying attachment which is a small sample of my work (which in its entirety spans 459 pages).

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Henri Branken